A DOSE OF REALITY

NON-FICTION SHOWS ARE BEGINNING TO FIND ***AN AUDIENCE IN INDIA, ENCOURAGING STREAMING PLATFORMS*** *TO BROADEN THEIR PROGRAMMING SLATE*

BY SUHANI SINGH

AI ABHISHEK HAS BEEN developing non-fiction programming for Discovery for over a decade, but he firmly believes 2023 was a watershed year for the genre on streaming. Head of factual and lifestyle cluster, South Asia, Warner Bros. Discovery, which includes Discovery Plus, an OTT platform reserved for non-fiction programming, Abhishek reminds you how the first Indian production to win an Oscar was a documentary (*The Elephant Whisperers*) and how with Amazon Prime and Netflix joining the fray, the hours devoted to factual programming have increased. Netflix perhaps set the ball rolling, when it gave us a glimpse of the elusive filmmaker Aditya Chopra in *The Romantics*, followed by the fascinating *The Hunt for Veerappan*; Amazon Prime scored a hit with *Dancing on the Grave*, about the Shakereh Khaleeli murder case, and drew acclaim for *Cinema Marte Dum Tak*, a love letter to the pulp film industry of the 1990s; while Discovery Plus got eyeballs for

